

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | CrowdStrike NG-SIEM | Detection Engineering | SOAR | XDR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with deep expertise in security information and event management (SIEM) engineering, detection content development, and threat-led security monitoring across hybrid cloud and on-premises environments. I have designed, deployed, and continuously improved SIEM capabilities using CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, building threat-led detection use cases, Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytic rules, playbooks, and security orchestration, automation and response (SOAR) workflows that drive measurable improvements in detection fidelity and analyst efficiency. I have extensive experience with log source onboarding, data source integration, and security event correlation across Microsoft Cloud services, Microsoft 365, endpoints, identity platforms, and on-premises data centres. I bring strong proficiency with the Microsoft Extended Detection and Response (XDR) suite including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, and I apply the MITRE ATT&CK framework to structure detection content and threat hunting activities at every stage of the investigation lifecycle.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM | Microsoft Sentinel | Splunk/SPL (working knowledge) | log source onboarding and data connector configuration | security event correlation and normalisation
- **Detection Content and Threat Hunting:** Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules and analytic queries | threat-led use case development | MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection engineering | threat hunting and proactive investigation | indicator of compromise (IoC) and indicator of attack (IoA) analysis
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Azure Logic Apps) | CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR | automated triage, containment, and notification workflows | playbook development and lifecycle management
- **XDR / EDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) | Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) | Microsoft 365 Defender | CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) | alert investigation and correlation across XDR and SIEM telemetry
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Azure | Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) | Conditional Access | Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) | cloud security monitoring and posture assessment
- **Log Sources and Integrations:** Windows event logs | Azure Activity and Diagnostic logs | Microsoft 365 audit logs | endpoint telemetry | identity and access logs | network and firewall logs | API-based data source integration
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident handling | alert triage and escalation | containment, eradication, and recovery | post-incident review and reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io | AppCheck | Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) | Nessus
- **Scripting:** PowerShell | KQL | SOAR automation scripting
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK | NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) | CIS Controls | ISO 27001 | Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP | CompTIA Security+ | Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA) | CompTIA A+ | Google IT Support Professional

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Design, deploy, and continuously improve SIEM monitoring capabilities using CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, spanning Microsoft Cloud services, Microsoft 365, on-premises data centres, and endpoint telemetry across a complex hybrid environment.
- Develop threat-led detection use cases, Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytic rules, and custom hunting queries aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling proactive identification of adversary techniques including credential harvesting, lateral movement, privilege escalation, and data exfiltration.
- Own log source onboarding and data connector configuration, integrating Windows event logs, Azure Activity logs, Microsoft 365 audit logs, endpoint telemetry, identity platform logs, and network device logs into SIEM platforms for unified security monitoring.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel (Azure Logic Apps) and CrowdStrike Fusion, automating alert triage, account isolation, indicator blocking, ticket creation, and stakeholder notification to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Conduct Microsoft Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert investigation across Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, correlating cross-domain signals within Microsoft Sentinel for accelerated root-cause analysis.
- Perform threat hunting campaigns using SIEM and EDR telemetry, applying MITRE ATT&CK-driven hypotheses to surface undetected adversary activity and feed findings back into the detection engineering pipeline.
- Lead incident response in line with the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating containment, eradication, and recovery across security and IT operations teams, and producing post-incident reports with lessons-learned and control improvement recommendations.
- Tune and optimise SIEM detection content continuously, reviewing alert volumes, false positive rates, and detection coverage gaps to maintain a high-fidelity monitoring environment with minimal analyst fatigue.
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), correlating vulnerability data with SIEM telemetry to prioritise risk-based remediation.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Operated and maintained Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, writing KQL analytic rules and workbooks to support detection, investigation, and reporting across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, configuring detection policies, exclusion lists, and custom Indicators of Attack (IoAs) to improve endpoint detection accuracy and reduce false positive volumes.
- Performed alert triage and first-line investigation of SIEM security events, escalating confirmed incidents through the incident response lifecycle in accordance with NIST 800-61 procedures.
- Contributed to the development of SOAR automation workflows, creating Microsoft Sentinel playbooks to automate common response actions including user account disabling, IP blocking, and security team notification.
- Onboarded new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, configuring data connectors and custom parsers to normalise security event data from endpoint, identity, email, and network sources.
- Conducted structured threat hunting activities using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Insight, applying MITRE ATT&CK techniques as hunting hypotheses to identify suspicious patterns not captured by existing analytic rules.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) and Conditional Access, monitoring identity-related alerts and anomalies through Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Sentinel UEBA (User and Entity Behaviour Analytics) capabilities.
- Supported Tenable.io vulnerability scanning and AppCheck assessment programmes, triaging findings against SIEM security context to identify actively exploited vulnerabilities requiring urgent remediation.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Managed security monitoring and event logging for a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech platform, ensuring comprehensive log collection from infrastructure, application, and identity systems to support threat detection and compliance requirements.

- Maintained endpoint detection and response tooling, reviewing and acting on security alerts, and supporting incident response activities for detected threats.
- Administered Active Directory and Group Policy, enforcing least-privilege access controls and supporting compliance audits under ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and security configuration reviews, coordinating remediation activities and maintaining risk registers to track progress against identified security gaps.
- Developed security policies and operational procedures, ensuring alignment with recognised frameworks including ISO 27001 and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF).

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built an end-to-end SIEM detection engineering programme at UAL, developing over 50 custom KQL analytic rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, resulting in a measurable reduction in mean time to detect (MTTD) and a significant improvement in the fidelity of alerts reaching security operations analysts.
- Led the onboarding of multiple new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel including Azure Active Directory sign-in logs, Microsoft 365 unified audit logs, CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry, and network device syslog, providing unified visibility across a complex hybrid estate.
- Designed and deployed a suite of SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Azure Logic Apps, automating high-frequency response actions including compromised account quarantine, phishing email remediation, and cross-team incident notification, reducing manual analyst effort by an estimated 40 percent for common alert types.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM to complement Microsoft Sentinel, integrating endpoint detection and response (EDR) telemetry with identity and cloud data to deliver a unified cross-domain threat detection and investigation capability covering 8,000 users.
- Conducted a structured MITRE ATT&CK coverage assessment against the organisation's SIEM detection rule library, identifying and closing gaps in coverage for high-priority techniques and improving overall detection coverage by implementing new use cases for credential access, persistence, and collection tactics.
- Achieved Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, demonstrating advanced knowledge across security operations, risk management, identity and access management, network security, and security architecture domains.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)